

Workshop card handoff

3 slots per layout record · 3 layout records · 7 source records · 2 padding slots

A layout record is one output data row, not a page. This tool does not predict pagination, frame removal, text overset, typography or image availability. A blank merge field does not remove its template frame.

Use a fixed-slot template

Bind one output record to your existing template's repeated slot frames. Insert real fields using the application's Data Merge panel. Do not type bracketed field names and assume they are placeholders. The field tokens below persist within the saved recipe; exact original headers identify source columns during an Update source operation.

Binding map

Generated field	Source column	Exact original header	Kind
slot_1_f003	3	Title	text
slot_1_f004	4	Detail	text
@slot_1_f005	5	Image path	image
slot_2_f003	3	Title	text
slot_2_f004	4	Detail	text
@slot_2_f005	5	Image path	image
slot_3_f003	3	Title	text
slot_3_f004	4	Detail	text
@slot_3_f005	5	Image path	image

Metadata fields

mp_layout_record, mp_group_index and group chunk counters are one-based. mp_grouped distinguishes disabled grouping from an exact blank group label. mp_slot_count is occupied slots in that record. Each slot has present (1 or 0), source_record (data ordinal after the header, not physical line number) and source_id (exact selected ID, or empty). Padding has present=0 and empty source/value fields. Real blank source records have present=1.

Grouping and order

Group order follows first appearance; source order is retained inside each group. Equal noncontiguous groups are collected together. Global source order has changed. placement.csv / placement.json records every source row's destination; project JSON retains the complete original table, including unselected columns.

Image fields

The @ prefix is the first character of each explicitly selected image-path field. Paths are copied unchanged. MergePanel never opens, fetches, resolves, rewrites or packages images. Relative paths depend on the exported data file's location. Asset existence, permissions and native import must be checked separately.

Multiline policy

Profile: generic; policy: preserve. Generic mode preserves quoted line breaks. The conservative InDesign mode blocks multiline values by default; explicit space mode replaces each CRLF pair, lone CR/LF or Unicode line/paragraph separator in selected text with one space and records every changed cell. Image paths and group/ID identities are always blocked if multiline in that profile. Adobe's current source-file page contains both a prohibition and a quoted-multiline support statement; this is our conservative policy, not a claim that InDesign cannot support multiline.

Merge export is allowed under the selected policy. Changed cells: 0. Blocked occurrences: 0. Keep changes.json with any transformed output. No named InDesign version has been tested.

CSV handling

Machine merge.csv preserves the selected policy's values and image headers. Quoting does not neutralize spreadsheet formulas. The separate review CSV prefixes formula-like text with an apostrophe, including @ image headers, and must not be used for native merge or exact round trips. Spreadsheet handling varies.

Primary sources

[Adobe source-file requirements](#) · [Adobe field and image binding](#)